

A few ideas for the business you may want to start

Servicing of office electronics equipment. This seems like a successful business idea that does not require any investment until you start expanding. The target could be small and medium business firms, since they might not have the time to repair or service their electronics equipment. With a small servicing kit, regular servicing can be offered, so that it becomes a long-term profitable business.

Electronics/PCB components assembly. This is a work-from-home, minimal investment freelance option, where you can offer electronics assembly services to local low-cost business and consumer electronics products. You could definitely expand later on.

PCB CAD design services. This is a minimal investment freelance job that allows you to work from home, and there is a possibility of growing in the future. You can offer electronics PCB CAD design services to small companies and professionals who cannot maintain in-house PCB CAD design tools and resources.

The power-supply equipment business. The demand for power supply regulation and energy storage has been growing. You can design and build your own power supply products (UPS systems, inverters, SMPS, etc) and sell them to individual customers. Servicing these power supply equipment will provide a good profit after the warranty period has expired.

Designing and manufacturing electronics home appliances. This is a very good home business opportunity—you can choose a good low-cost home appliance solution like an electronic mosquito killer, electronic healthcare gadget, etc.

Cell-phone service and repairs. There are good opportunities for repairing or recycling old mobile phones and selling them at cheaper prices.

Computer and laptop repairs. This is an easy-to-set up business as the computers and laptops are built with easily-replaceable PC boards and modules. You can earn more money in less time.

Power electronics appliance service and repairs. This is a continually growing business opportunity with the increasing number of electronic appliances in homes. These appliances are expensive, and have to be constantly serviced or repaired before they reach their end of life.

Electronic products and components supply chain management. With the wholesale purchase of electronic products and their service components, and their distribution to retail suppliers, you can make good money with less investment, as no expensive infrastructure is required.

Building or installation of home solar power generation equipment. You can learn the basics of solar power systems and how to install them, and then start winning contracts with just an installation tool-kit.

Research and development. Use your advanced knowledge in circuitry to test and create products that you can sell with your own research and development firm, or that companies can hire for unbiased test results and consultations. You could work with green building products, machinery controls, navigation systems, communication systems, wiring systems and lighting products.

Maintenance and repair. Electrical and electronics engineers develop the circuitry inside electronic equipment and vehicles, and this knowledge can serve others who require maintenance and repairs. For example, if you specialise in the electrical components in automobiles, you can contract your services to a car manufacturer that wants to fix a never-before-seen sound system that is not performing well in its latest line of cars.

Printed circuit boards. One of the most important components within an electronic product is the circuit board. Using your skills, you can design and sell printed circuit boards to manufacturing companies, construction firms and engineering firms that do not specialise in electrical engineering. By purchasing special automated equipment, you can design and print a large number of circuit boards for clients who require such boards.

(Courtesy: www.electronicshubs.com & <http://smallbusiness.chron.com>)

(it was Motorola at that time) and he made his first product at almost zero cost.

According to an online study, over 75 per cent of respondents believe it

is important to look for information about people and their organisation before doing business with them. So it would not be wrong to say that an online presence must be considered

whilst setting up a start-up. Chaddha believes it is a must. He says, "There is no way anyone can do business without having an online presence. If someone has to find out anything about you, the first thing that he or she will do is to look up the Internet."

Sunder says, "If you are not easily found on the Internet, your customers will never find you." Subramaniam adds, "Branding is definitely very important. Unless your company is on the stealth mode, in which case one does not want to reveal too many details about an idea or product, I would say an online presence is very important."

Talking about government help for start-ups, Chaddha elaborates, "There is a government entity called NIESBUD in Noida, where I have been invited a few times to speak about entrepreneurship to students of several colleges. The government of India is anchoring and mentoring students to start their own businesses and it has continuously been conducting courses for them. There are plenty of (business) incubators coming up. I'm sure there are quite a few in Bengaluru also, although I don't have a clear idea about them. But in Delhi, there are colleges with incubators where their students, as well as students from different colleges, are encouraged to work together. There are some schemes available where the government lends a small amount of money, though there is a lot of bureaucracy with respect to this."

This information is just the tip of the iceberg with regard to all that entrepreneurs need to know about getting a business off the ground, so break out of your comfort zone and learn as much as you can about the field you are getting into. Believing that nothing can prepare young people better for success than a strong math and science background, President Obama also noted that "...the most common course of study for S&P's (Standard & Poor) 500 CEOs was not business, finance or economics, but engineering." ●

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